2. Soil Conservation: Soyabean provides organic matter; fixes atmospheric nitrogen up to 40% while its fibrous roots penetrate the soil thereby improving soil aeration, water absorption and retention capacity.

3. Livestock feeds: Soyabean is a source of protein for livestock feeds formulation.

4. Cash Income: Soyabean is a tradable commodity that can improve economic status of famers.

Varieties

KARI Released Varieties

Variety	Suitable areas	Maturit Days	Yield	Oil %
931/5/34	0-2000	4-5	1.5-3	24
DPSB19	900-2400	3-4	0.6-1.7	17
DPSB8	900-2400	4-5	0.6-1.7	18
Nyala	1200-2400	4-4.5	1.2-2.5	19
Gazelle	1200-2400	4-5	0.8-2.5	22
Hill	1200-2400	3.5-4.5	0.8-2.5	21
Black Hawk	900-2400-	4-5	0.8-1.8	18
AI3600	800-1700	4-5	0.5-2.5	18

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SOYA BEANS PRODUCTION IN KENYA

Introduction

Soyabean is a crop with high quality protein (35-40) % and oil (18-20) % maturing in 3 to 6 months depending on the variety and prevailing climatic conditions. There are both erect and creeping varieties of soyabean.

Agronomic requirements

Soyabeans do well in areas with 300-1200 mm of rainfall and at an altitude range of 0-2200 m. asl. The soils should be deep, well drained and pH of 5-6.

Planting

Use recommended variety at a seed rate of 20-30 kgs/acre. Plant at a depth of 2.5-5 cm. The soil should be adequately moist and warm when planting. Plant manually at a spacing of 45 cm x 10 cm. Machine planting at a spacing of 30 cm x 15 cm.

Weed Control

When growing Soyabean on small scale, weeding can be carried out 2-3 times within the growing season. Post and pre-emergent herbicides ( ) are available for large scale farming.

Weed free Soyabean crop

Weed free Soyabean crop

Pests and pest Control

These include; cutworms, aphids, leafhoppers, antestia bugs, beetles and spider mites. These pests can be controlled with appropriate pesticides available from agricultural input outlets.

Common Diseases

They include; rusts, wet blotch, septoria, Soyabean mosaic virus, Fusarium, Frog eye bacterial blight and charcoal rot.

Disease control

1. Use dressed seed for planting.
2. Spray with appropriate fungicides if disease symptoms are spotted.
3. Rogue out diseased plants.
4. Practise crop rotation.
5. Use resistant varieties.

Maturity

Soyabeans are ready for harvesting when all the leaves are shed off, the pods turn brown and seeds make a rattling sound when plants are shaken.

Cut stems at the ground level, leave them in the sun momentarily, thresh manually when ready or store in a well-aerated place before threshing. Mechanized harvesting can be done for erect varieties with a pod clearance above 15cm.

Yields

Yields in Kenya averages (800-1200) kg/ha.

Benefits of Soyabeans

Soyabeans may be grown and used for food and and feeds. Both household and industrial markets are expanding. So is the use of soyabean in soils improvement and crop rotation programs.

1. Nutrition: Soyabean is an excellent source of farm grown protein. It is a source of essential omega three fatty acids, minerals and vitamins.